Product priorities template - Verve-PM

Description

This product prioritization template provides three key methods for aligning efforts across the company.

It recognizes that a typical product initiative involves multiple departments, including engineering, UX, and product, and may extend to teams like marketing and customer success, which may need to develop supporting campaigns, messaging, or update internal processes.

The template accounts for the complexity of coordinating across various teams, their preparedness, and the confidence levels in executing the initiative.

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Method 1: ICE

ICE, coined by Sean Ellis, stands for Impact, Confidence, and Effort.

- **Impact**: The potential influence the initiative will have on growth or business success. For example, changing the onboarding for all customers has a high impact while updating the flow of our least used menu item has a low impact.
- **Confidence**: How certain the team is that the initiative will succeed, based on data or experience. For example, optimizing website speed for better SEO has a high confidence based on Google's recommendation. On the other end, building a new referral program to improve sales will have a low confidence.
- **Ease**: How easy it is to implement (lower dev time, fewer resources). For example, a minor bug will have a score of 10 while training a new model will be closer to 3.

The total score is calculated using this formula

ICE Score= (I×C×E)/ 3

Example:

Initiative	Impact (1-10)	Confidence (1-10)	Ease (1-10)	Average ICE Score	Priority
1. New region onboarding flow	8	7	6	**112**	High
2. Referral program launch	2	5	4	**13.3**	Medium
3. Upgrade to Tav-8 homepage	5	9	6	**90**	High
4. Website speed optimization	5	8	2	**26.7**	High
5. German translation of the whole app	3	2	1	**2.0**	Medium

Subset of Method 1: RICE

This methods adds R or Reach to the scoring of the ICE method

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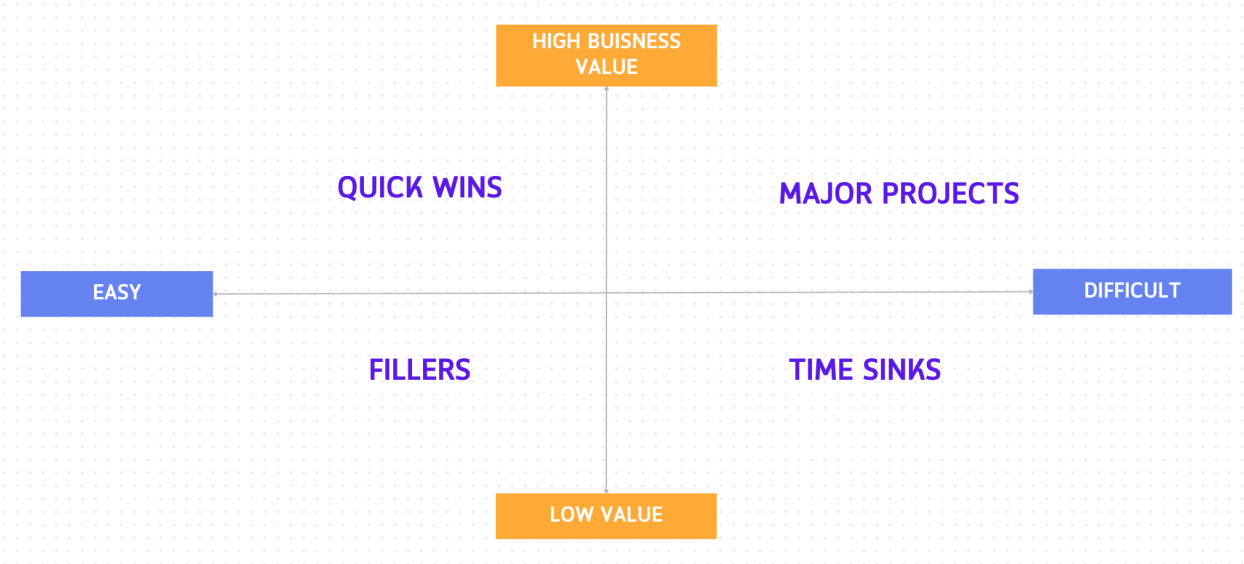
Method 2 Value vs Complexity Quadrant



Quadrant Breakdown:

1. **Quick Wins**: High Value, Low Complexity
   - Description: These initiatives are easy to implement and provide significant benefits. They should be prioritized first.
   - Examples: Minor feature tweaks, quick bug fixes, or optimizations based on user feedback that can be executed with minimal resources.
2. **Major Projects**: High Value, High Complexity
   - Description: These initiatives promise substantial benefits but require considerable resources and time. They should be planned carefully and may be scheduled for later phases.
   - Examples: Launching a new product line, entering a new market, or redesigning the entire user interface.
3. **Fillers**: Low Value, Low Complexity
   - Description: These projects are easy to implement but don’t add significant value. They can be considered if there are available resources, but they shouldn’t be a priority.
   - Examples: Cosmetic changes to a website or minor updates that don't impact functionality.
4. **Time Sinks**: Low Value, High Complexity
   - Description: These initiatives are difficult to implement and provide minimal value. They should generally be avoided or deprioritized.
   - Examples: Legacy feature enhancements or complex projects that are unlikely to resonate with users.

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Method 3: MoSCoW

MoSCoW stands for:

M - Must-Have	These are non-negotiable, critical requirements that must be included in the final product or project. Without them, the project would be considered a failure or incomplete.
S - Should-Have	Important requirements that add significant value but are not absolutely critical for launch. If not included, they may cause some inconvenience, but there are workarounds.
C - Could-Have	These are nice-to-have features that would enhance the product but are not essential. They have a lower impact and can be deprioritized if time or resources are constrained.
W - Won't-Have (for now)	These are features or requirements that are agreed to be out of scope for the current project but may be considered for future releases.

Breakdown of the Categories:

1. **Must-Have**:
    - **Examples**: Core functionalities like user login for an app, payment processing for an e-commerce site, or legal compliance features.
    - **Impact**: If any "Must-Haves" are not delivered, the project cannot go live.
2. **Should-Have**:
    - **Examples**: Advanced reporting features, improved UX/UI elements, or additional payment options.
    - **Impact**: The project can still be delivered without them, but their inclusion is highly desirable.
3. **Could-Have**:
    - **Examples**: Social sharing features, additional customization options, or extra languages.
    - **Impact**: The absence of "Could-Have" features won't significantly affect the project's success.
4. **Won't-Have (for now)**:
    - **Examples**: Complex features that could be part of future updates, such as AI-driven recommendations or advanced analytics.

- **Impact**: Won’t impact the current delivery timeline as these are explicitly deprioritized for now.